

Garbage Disposal Humming Jammed — Action Checklist

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DIAGNOSE THE SOUND

- ☐ **Listen for the Problem:** Stand beneath your fan and identify the specific sound it makes when you flip the switch—humming means a blocked motor, clicking means loose blade screws, and screeching means dry bearings.
- ☐ **Perform the Five-Second Test:** Look directly at the blades, listen to the exact sound the motor makes, and test all three speed settings before touching anything so you know exactly what you're fixing.
- ☐ **Rule Out Electrical Causes:** Try the wall switch, the remote control, and the circuit breaker first—many problems that seem mechanical are actually simple power issues you can fix without tools.
- ☐ **Check for Capacitor Symptoms:** Note if your fan works on only one speed or hums without starting, which signals a failing capacitor that needs replacement rather than manual clearing.

CLEAR THE JAM

- ☐ **Locate the Hex Socket:** Find the small hex-shaped socket at the very bottom center of the fan motor housing where the motor shaft ends, which is your manual access point for freeing a stuck motor.
- ☐ **Free the Motor Manually:** Insert an Allen wrench into the hex socket and rotate it back and forth several times to physically dislodge whatever is blocking the motor shaft from spinning freely.
- ☐ **Clear Debris from Housing:** Remove the motor cover and clean out any accumulated dust, debris, or foreign objects that may have settled around the motor shaft and contributed to the blockage.
- ☐ **Tighten All Blade Screws:** Inspect each blade where it attaches to the fan body and tighten any loose screws with a screwdriver to prevent the flexing and clicking that worsens over time.

VERIFY THE FIX

- ☐ **Test All Three Speeds:** After clearing the jam, turn the fan on at low, medium, and high settings to verify the blades spin smoothly without humming, clicking, or wobbling at any speed.
 - ☐ **Confirm Smooth Rotation:** Watch the blades for at least 30 seconds to ensure they continue spinning freely without stalling or making irregular sounds that would indicate the blockage wasn't fully cleared.
 - ☐ **Listen for Unusual Noise:** Pay attention to any grinding, squeaking, or intermittent sounds that might reveal a partially cleared obstruction or another underlying issue you need to address.
 - ☐ **Note Persistent Problems:** If the fan still hums, won't start, or works on only one speed after manual clearing, document the specific symptoms so you can accurately describe them if you need professional help.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.